

A Mornington Peninsula *Spring*

Ridge afternoons soft with new growth, market season opening on the bay, and the weeks before the summer crowds arrive — this is the underrated Peninsula.

Eight pages · Six venues · One sample weekend · Updated May 2026

Spring is the locals' season.

The Peninsula's two best-kept secrets are autumn and spring. Autumn gets the photographs; spring gets the weather. The vintage has just gone in the ground on the ridge, the markets are pulling out of winter, the back-bay walks are warm enough to enjoy without being so warm that the bay swimming is mandatory. Tourism is still asleep through October.

This guide is six venues we'd commit to in spring, framed by a sample two-night plan that leans light on the schedule. Spring rewards loafing.

The six

1. Red Hill Estate

\$\$\$ · RED HILL

One of the Peninsula's most photographed cellar-door views, home to Max's Restaurant and a well-regarded traditional-method sparkling program

2. Montalto Vineyard & Olive Grove

\$\$\$ · RED HILL

Single Vineyard Pinot Noir and a Sunday lunch beneath the olive grove canopy

3. Paringa Estate

\$\$\$ · RED HILL

A serious single-vineyard producer with one of the Peninsula's most dependable restaurant terraces

4. Foxeys Hangout

\$\$ · RED HILL

Biodynamic Red Hill estate with an all-day deck, sunny long lunches, and a sparkling program that holds its own against French fizz

5. Hotel Sorrento

\$\$\$ · SORRENTO

A grand old bay-facing pub-hotel whose best rooms still make Sorrento feel gloriously old-school

6. Pt. Leo Estate

\$\$\$ · MERRICKS

A sculpture park walk followed by a long bay-view lunch in the glass-walled restaurant

A sample spring weekend

Friday evening

Drive down. Light dinner near the hotel; the days are getting longer, so dinner can be late and the next morning isn't a rush. Walk the bay before bed.

Saturday morning

Red Hill Market or a Mornington Saturday — check the calendar. Spring is when the market season finds its rhythm again. Coffee at one of the village locals; stay slow.

Saturday afternoon

The cellar doors. The vintage just went in the ground; staff have time to talk you through what's coming. Pick two; lunch at one. A coast walk at 5 if the light is on.

Sunday morning

Slow breakfast. A back-bay walk. Lunch is a counter meal at a Sorrento or Flinders pub. Drive home before traffic builds — by 3 pm the road is yours.

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This guide was produced May 2026. The live site supersedes; check before you book.